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## *Appendix C: Lead Letter and Package Contents*

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## **POINT OF CONTACT LEAD LETTER**

**U.S. Department of Labor**

Assistant Secretary for  
Employment and Training  
Washington, D.C. 20210



July 26, 1999

Ted Williams  
Director of Human Resources  
Research Triangle Institute  
P.O. Box 12194  
RTP, NC 27709

Dear Mr. Williams:

A few days from now you will receive in the mail a request to assist the U.S. Department of Labor with an important research project, the Occupational Information Network (O\*NETTM). The O\*NET program is our nation's primary source of occupational information.

I'm writing to you in advance in the hope that you will be able to schedule time to review the forthcoming request. The project is an important one that will help the Department of Labor, professional associations, and business and human resource professionals understand the qualifications and skills of today's rapidly changing workforce.

Be aware that participation in this effort is voluntary. Please be aware that your participation in this effort is voluntary. We estimate your total effort will be less than 90 minutes over the next four to six weeks. You are encouraged to send any comments regarding this burden estimate or any other aspect of this collection of information to the U.S. Department of Labor, Office of Policy and Research, 200 Constitution Avenue, N.W, Room N5637, Washington, D.C. 20210 (refer to OMB Control Number 1205-XXX).

Thank you for your time and consideration. It's only with the experience and expertise of people like you that our research can be successful.

Sincerely,

U.S. Department of Labor

## **POINT OF CONTACT ADVANCE PACKAGE**

Bonnie Steinberg  
750 Milwaukee  
Dunedin, FL 34698

August 6, 2000

Dear Ms. Steinberg:

I am writing to you regarding a research program called O\*NETTM, or the Occupational Information Network. The O\*NET program is sponsored by the U. S. Department of Labor, the National O\*NET Consortium, and the Research Triangle Institute (RTI). This research program is part of an effort to collect new and expanded data directly from thousands of job incumbents from businesses all across the United States. The results will be used to update the O\*NET database, which is the nation's primary source of occupational information. It is used by employers, job seekers, trainers, and labor market analysts across the country and contains comprehensive information on job requirements and worker competencies. RTI, a not-for-profit research organization located in North Carolina, has been contracted to collect these data. I would like you to partner with the Department of Labor and RTI in building the O\*NET database.

Your company has been statistically selected for this data collection effort. During a preliminary screening call made to your business by an RTI research professional, you were identified as someone who is very familiar with and knowledgeable about the classification of jobs within your organization. I ask that you participate in this national effort by agreeing to be the point of contact (POC) at your company for the O\*NET Data Collection Program. POCs will help us select employees who will be asked to complete a questionnaire.

Included in this package, you will find a letter from Mr. Randall Keesling, the RTI project director managing the O\*NET data collection effort. IFEs letter describes in more detail what we'd like you to contribute to the data collection process. Included is some information you will need to help select the employee respondents from your organization. You will find a brochure describing O\*NET, which may answer any additional questions you have about the project and lists the various agencies endorsing O\*NET. Finally, please accept the enclosed token of our appreciation for your consideration of these materials.

I'd like you to know that once you agree to participate, we will send your organization [BUSINESS INCENTIVE]. Thank you in advance for your assistance.

Please be assured that your participation is voluntary. We estimate your total effort will be less than 90 minutes over the next four to six weeks. The selected employees will each spend an average of 30 minutes completing a questionnaire ***on their own time***. If you have any comments or suggestions regarding this burden estimate or any other aspect of the data collection, please send them to the U.S. Department of Labor, Office of Policy and Research, Room N-5637, 200 Constitution Avenue NW, Washington DC 20210 (refer to OMB Control Number 1205-XXXX).

Sincerely,

[SOMEONE AT DOL]

RESEARCH TRIANGLE INSTITUTE

Dear Colleague:

The O\*NET<sup>™</sup> Data Collection Program requires your assistance to keep the O\*NET database current. The letter enclosed in this package from XX at the U.S. Department of Labor explained to you the importance of the O\*NET project. I'd like to provide you with a few more details about what your participation will entail.

Your voluntary participation will involve interacting with a research professional from RTI via telephone to: 1) assist in the random selection of employees in specific occupations from your business, and 2) distribute a questionnaire packet to each selected employee. The selected employee will return the completed questionnaire directly to RTI via business reply mail. We estimate your total effort will be less than 90 minutes over the next four to six weeks. The selected employees will each spend an average of 30 minutes completing a questionnaire **on their own time**. If you have any comments or suggestions regarding this burden estimate or any other aspect of the data collection, please send them to the U.S. Department of Labor, Office of Policy and Research, Room N-5637, 200 Constitution Avenue NW, Washington DC 20210 (refer to OMB Control Number 1205-XXXX).

In about a week, a member of the RTI research team will contact you to discuss your participation and answer any questions or concerns that you may have. I have enclosed an O\*NET brochure that further explains the program and its importance. In addition, I have included an information sheet that goes into more detail about your participation as well as that of the employees, and Identification Profiles for each selected occupation at your business. An RTI research professional will be calling you in a few days to discuss these materials.

If you have any questions or concerns before our telephone call, you may contact [SPECIALIST NAME] toll free at 1 (877)-254-1842, Ext. 73. If you have any questions regarding your rights as a research participant, you may contact Dr. Wendy Visscher, chair of the Institutional Review Board at RTI at 1-800-334-8571, ext. 6028. You may receive additional information regarding the O\*NET Data Collection Program by visiting our web site at <http://onet.rti.org>. Thank you for your consideration and anticipated participation in this extremely important research program.

Sincerely

Randall Keesling  
RTI Project Director

beyond information.

intelligence.





# beyond information. intelligence.

## Hire intelligence.

\* Rapidly changing world markets and vast technological innovation. Increasing competition at home and abroad. Rising customer expectations. For employers and job seekers alike, staying competitive in today's demanding workplace means making smart choices in all employment decisions. \* At the same time, occupational information is everywhere—in books, newspapers, websites, magazines, and elsewhere. But most sources only give part of the picture. Without standardization in the business of employment, compiling, customizing, and maintaining occupational data can be a cumbersome, ongoing process.

## Fortunately, the business of employment just got smarter.

O\*NET is a unique, powerful source for continually updated occupational information and labor market research. By using a contemporary, interactive skills-based database and a common language to describe worker skills and attributes, O\*NET transforms mountains of data into precise, focused occupational intelligence that anyone can understand easily and efficiently.

### WHO USES O\*NET?

- HR personnel
- Training facilitators
- Students
- Workforce researchers
- Career counselors
- Efficiency experts
- Rehabilitation counselors
- Job seekers
- Software developers
- Displaced workers
- Business forecasters
- Industry analysts
- Educators at all levels
- Organizational consultants

# O\*NET in it

**\* Get O\*NET in it.** Some of the most sophisticated occupational systems in the world contain one powerful, unique ingredient: O\*NET. Software and system developers can meet your specific needs by customizing O\*NET's powerful, flexible data to your own organization's applications. \* O\*NET contains information from some of the nation's top occupational researchers and analysts. They have collected and classified this knowledge to guarantee that O\*NET intelligence is accurate, current, consistent, and comprehensive.

**Look for the seal.** All software applications and other resources powered by O\*NET data will now display the official "O\*NET in-it" seal on their packaging. Look for it to find the most dynamic intelligence on today's U.S. labor market.



O\*NET will help us keep our internal job descriptions, appraisals, and training up-to-date. Rather than spend our time collecting data, we will have more time to focus on developing our workforce.

—James B. McGregor,  
Morgal Machine Tool Company

# O\*NET in action

## More than a database—a solution.

O\*NET integrates a powerful, relational database, a common language for job and skill descriptions, and crosswalks to other classification systems into a complete solution for businesses, job seekers, and workforce development professionals. As the most comprehensive occupation resource available, O\*NET helps workforce professionals:

- DEVELOP** detailed, accurate job descriptions.
- IDENTIFY** interest and experience requirements to align the right candidate with the right job.
- DESIGN** relevant career curricula and occupational skills development programs.
- DEFINE** success factors for promotion and advancement.
- FORECAST** HR requirements more effectively.

## Tools you can use.

Whether it's finding and retaining the right people, developing more effective job descriptions, or just getting the most recent occupational information available, O\*NET is your complete solution for keeping up with today's rapidly changing world of work. O\*NET offers:

- Current, detailed information on more than 900 occupations.
- More than 450 standardized descriptors of skills, abilities, interests, knowledge, and work context.
- Standard occupational classification (SOC) coding.
- Easy-to-use interface and search menus.
- Skill-searchable occupational descriptions for more exact career targeting.
- Tools to build accurate job descriptions.
- Crosswalks to other classification systems and links to placement and labor market resources.
- Accommodation information to use as a disability counseling tool.

O\*NET helps employers by giving them very current information to help in the designing of organizational, recruiting, training, and compensation systems.

—Michael D. Bass,  
Sears Roebuck & Co.

# the power of O\*NET

**BUSINESSES AND  
HR PROFESSIONALS**

**JOB SEEKERS**

## USE O\*NET TO FIND—AND KEEP:

### QUALIFIED JOB CANDIDATES

- Expand the pool of quality candidates for open positions.
- Develop effective job descriptions quickly and easily.
- Define employee and/or job-specific success factors.
- Align organizational development with workplace needs.
- Refine recruitment and training goals.
- Design competitive compensation and promotion systems.

### A QUALITY JOB

- Find out which jobs fit with your interests, skills, and experience.
- Explore growth career profiles using the latest available labor market data.
- Research what it takes to get your dream job.
- Maximize earning potential and job satisfaction.
- Know what it takes to be successful in your field and in related occupations.

What you're **looking** for.

## O\*NET ORGANIZES ITS WEALTH OF INFORMATION ABOUT EACH OCCUPATION INTO SEVEN, INTERRELATED AREAS:

### EXPERIENCE REQUIREMENTS

describe the education, training, skills, licensing, and experience required for entry and advancement.

### OCCUPATION REQUIREMENTS

outline the typical tasks associated with each occupation or group of occupations, including specific physical, social, or structural demands on workers.

### WORKER REQUIREMENTS

include individual performance factors, such as skills and knowledge, including basic skills and cross-functional skills.

### WORKER CHARACTERISTICS

represent the work styles, interests, and abilities that are important to job seekers evaluating potential career opportunities.

### OCCUPATION CHARACTERISTICS

include links to current labor market information on occupations, including wages, employment outlook, and industry size.

### OCCUPATION SPECIFIC INFORMATION

provides comprehensive details for a single occupation or narrowly-defined job family.

### RELATED OCCUPATIONS

cross-reference occupations that require similar knowledge, skills, and experience.



American Bar Association

American Business Conference

American Chemical Society

American Correctional Association

American Dental Assistants Association

American Dental Hygienists Association

American Geological Institute

American Institute for Building Design

American Institute of Aeronautics and Astronautics

American Institute of Engineers

American Nursery and Landscape Association

American Society of Certified Engineer Technicians

American Society of Interior Designers

American Society of Travel Agents

Architectural Engineering Institute of American Society of Civil Engineers

Associated Locksmiths of America

Association for Commuter Transportation

Chartered Property and Casualty Underwriters Society

Community Transportation Association

Food Service Consultants Society International

Hospitality Business Alliance

Inland Marine Underwriters Association

Independent Automotive Damage Appraisers Association

International Union of Police

Institute of Industrial Engineers

Insurance Information Institute

National Academy of Opticianry

National Alliance of Business

National Association of Child Care Professionals

National Association of Child Care Resource and Referral Agencies

National Bicycle Dealers Association

National Coalition for Advanced Manufacturing

National Institute for Metalworking Skills

National Paralegal Association

National Retail Federation

Owner-Operator Independent Drivers Association

Society for Foodservice Management

Society of Allied Weight Engineers

Society of Naval Architects and Marine Engineers

Society of Petroleum Engineers

## Association Endorsement

As leading national and industry associations, we support O\*NET, the Occupational Information Network. A major initiative of the United States Department of Labor, O\*NET is a database of occupation information, specifying job characteristics and worker skills and abilities.

O\*NET helps employers meet human resource challenges by identifying front line skill needs. It helps employees identify skills necessary to succeed in their fields, and helps job seekers understand the skills and training they need for the jobs they want.

We urge you to complete the O\*NET questionnaire. By providing this valuable information, you will help the O\*NET database capture the realities of the changing American workplace and be a participant in building a national labor exchange system able to compete in the international marketplace.





## **O\*NET Data Collection in Three Simple Steps ...**

### **1. Sampling**

- ◆ Verify that your business does employ staff in at least one of the specified occupations listed in your letter from Mr. Keesling of RTI. Your O\*NET project contact at RTI will help you use the Identification Profile on the opposite page.
- ◆ Your O\*NET project contact will instruct you on how to assist in the employee sampling process. In order to randomly select employees to complete the self-administered questionnaire, we first need to know the total number that are in each occupation at your business. We will also ask you to compile a numbered list of the names of the employees in each selected occupation.

### **2. Distribution**

- ◆ We will ship a package containing individually sealed packets for each selected employee directly to you for distribution.
- ◆ If you prefer, we can ship the individual packets directly to the selected employees. For this option, you would need to provide us with the individual names and business addresses.

### **3. Follow-up**

- ◆ We will rely on you to communicate to each selected employee that your organization is participating in this project and that they have been randomly selected to participate **if they choose to do so**. This can be done by memo, e-mail, phone call, or whatever method works best for you. To make this easy for you, we have a sample memo posted on our website that you may use as a guide.
- ◆ You will be called a few times during the course of 31 days after the employees (or you) receive the questionnaires. We will keep you informed of the project status and also make sure that everyone has received all materials.

## About Employee Questionnaires . . .

- ◆ There are four different O\*NET questionnaires; however, an employee will be asked to complete only one, which will be randomly assigned. Questionnaires (copies of which may be viewed on our website) consist of objective questions about skills, functions, characteristics, and requirements for identified occupations.
- ◆ Each selected employee will receive a packet that contains a questionnaire booklet and some explanatory materials. It will take about 30 minutes for an employee to complete the assigned questionnaire.
- ◆ Employees are encouraged to complete the questionnaire on their “off time” so this process will not interfere with their work obligations and responsibilities.
- ◆ Each employee will return his or her completed questionnaire to RTI using the postage-paid return envelope included in their packet. If an employee can access the Internet, he/she has the option of completing an online version of the questionnaire instead.
- ◆ All information that we receive from the questionnaire is **confidential**. ID numbers will be used to track questionnaires; **no names** will ever be linked with individual responses.

## Identification (ID) Profile Sheet

The ID Profile is a description of the O\*NET occupation being sampled. The ID Profile Sheet is a list of typical tasks and alternate titles that may identify the same occupation. Rather than a set of hard and fast rules, we would like for you to think of the ID Profile Sheet as a tool to help you decide if a job in your organization matches a specific O\*NET occupation.

The process of matching occupations in your organization to the ones on the ID Profile Sheet may seem confusing at first. For example, the title of an occupation may not match the Profile Sheet, while the task descriptions do. A helpful tip is to ask yourself if the work performed by the employee is similar to the ID Profile description. If so, you have a match, even if the title of the occupation at your organization differs from the one on the Profile Sheet. In other words, the process of matching occupations to the O\*NET ID Profile Sheet will involve several steps.

We have listed below steps we think will be useful to you while trying to complete the occupation identification process.

1. **Review the job definition.** If a job description in your organization is very similar to the definition in the ID Profile, you have a match, even if the title differs (see #2 below).
2. **Review the title.** Occupations can have many different titles, so a list of alternate titles is included as a reference—in most cases these occupations are acceptable for inclusion.
3. **Review the tasks.** The tasks may provide additional information to help you decide if the occupation is a match. However, please be alert to a couple of potentially confusing situations. Employees often perform a variety of tasks. Some of the tasks may not be listed in an occupation's ID Profile. Or one or more of the tasks may be performed by employees in different occupations within your organization. For these reasons, please be careful to review the job description and title as described above in steps 1 and 2 in addition to the tasks.
4. **Review the “The Following Occupations Are NOT”- section.** This section of the ID Profile Sheet describes occupations that should not be included in the data collection for the selected O\*NET occupation. Frequently, the occupations in the “are NOT” list may be similar to occupations we are interested in, but are classified separately in the O\*NET system.
5. **Review steps 1 - 4.** If after reviewing the job definition, title, tasks, and the “are NOT” list, you need help making the final determination, please do not hesitate to call your RTI/O\*NET contact person.

If you have any questions, comments, or concerns during any phase of the occupation identification process, please do not hesitate to call your contact person.



## **SELECTED EMPLOYEE PACKAGE**

**U.S. Department of Labor**

Assistant Secretary for  
Employment and Training  
Washington, D.C. 20210



August 6, 2000

Dear Survey Respondent:

Your company and the U.S. Department of Labor have teamed together to ask you to participate in an important nationwide project. We'd like to know more about the jobs you do and the skills you have acquired over the years. My goal at the Department of Labor is to use this information to improve the livelihood of America's workers.

Specifically, I'm asking you to help provide data to build the new foundation of America's workforce system, the O\*NET<sup>™</sup>, or Occupational Information Network. The data are being collected for the Department of Labor by Research Triangle Institute (RTI), a not-for-profit research company located in North Carolina. Enclosed you will find a letter from Mr. Randall Keesling, the RTI project director managing this data collection enterprise, which describes the project in more detail.

By completing the enclosed questionnaires, you will have a voice in defining the characteristics that distinguish the modern American workplace. In return, you will have access to information that communicates with precision the skills and training you need to advance your career. Your participation is voluntary and will only require about 30 minutes of your time. To make the process even more efficient, we offer you the opportunity to fill out the questionnaire on our web site. You will find instructions on how to do this in the enclosed materials.

If you have any comments or suggestions regarding this burden estimate or any other aspect of the data collection, please send them to the U.S. Department of Labor, Office of Policy and Research, Room N-5637, 200 Constitution Avenue NW, Washington DC 20210 (refer to OMB Control Number 1205-XXXX).

So please join with the employees across the country who are contributing their unique perspective to this comprehensive human resources tool. Employees, job seekers, employers, educators, and students across the United States will benefit as a result of your participation.

Sincerely,

August 6, 2000

Dear Survey Respondent:

You have been selected to participate in the Occupational Information Network (O\*NET<sup>®</sup>) Data Collection Program, conducted for the U.S. Department of Labor by our contractor, Research Triangle Institute (RTI). The O\*NET database is our nation's primary source of occupational information. We are collecting data on characteristics of workers and jobs directly from thousands of individuals in selected occupations from businesses across the United States.

The organization where you work has been statistically selected to participate. [POC NAME] from your company has agreed to help RTI randomly select employees in certain occupations to participate in the O\*NET Data Collection Program. You were selected through this process, and we now invite you to participate in this nationwide program.

**We are asking you to complete the enclosed questionnaire.** It should take you approximately 30 minutes to complete. **We ask that you do this on your own time, not company time. The enclosed \$10 is yours to keep for taking the time to read and process this material.**

**Your help is voluntary-you do not have to participate.** You may refuse to answer any question. Your answers will be completely confidential. No one in your organization will see your answers. Data will be used to describe occupations, not specific jobs or the individuals performing them. Your decision to participate or not to participate will not affect your employment. However, we hope you will help by completing the enclosed questionnaire.

Questions regarding any aspect of the data collection may be addressed to the U.S. Department of Labor, Office of Policy Research, Washington, DC 20210, (refer to OMB Number 1205-0400). If you have any questions regarding your rights as a research participant, you may contact Dr. Wendy Visscher, Chair of the Institutional Review Board at RTI at 1-800-334-8571, ext 6028.

Thank you for your support of O\*NET. The voluntary participation of employers and employees across the country in O\*NET data collection efforts will help to ensure that all data contained in the O\*NET system is accurate.

Sincerely,

Randall Keesling  
RTI Project Director

3040 Cornwallis Road - Post Office Box 12194 - Research Triangle Park, North Carolina 27709-2194 USA  
Telephone 919 541-6000 - Fax 919 541-5985



## Participation Information Sheet for Survey Respondents

Thank you for your cooperation and participation in this important nationwide program! As Mr. Keesling explained in his letter to you, all the information that we get from you is **confidential**. Your name and your company's name **will not be identified** in any data released or published as a result of this data collection.

There are two ways that you can fill out the questionnaire. You can fill out the hard copy version included in this packet, or you can complete the questionnaire by using an online version. By accessing our website, you can complete and send the questionnaire in one step. We believe you will find the online version easy to use, especially if you are familiar with using Windows-based computer software and accessing the Internet via a web browser. However, we understand that not everyone is comfortable using or has access to the Internet. If this is the case for you, please feel free to complete the hard copy version. **We appreciate your time and effort either way!** If you do chose to use our online web version, be assured that your responses are confidential and are protected by the same technology used by businesses to secure credit card numbers. Below we provide instructions for both methods.

### Instructions for Completing the Hard Copy Questionnaire:

- Read the instructions at the beginning of each section of your questionnaire booklet carefully. Examples are given to assist you. **Please begin with the Task Questionnaire that is stapled to the inside cover of your booklet.**
- After you have completed the questionnaire, place it in the return envelope provided and seal it. Be sure to include the Task Questionnaire in the return envelope.
- Please complete and return the questionnaire booklet within the next **2 weeks**.
- Drop the envelope in the mail (no postage is needed). It's that easy!

### Instructions for Completing the Web Version of the Questionnaire:

- You need version 3.0 or higher of Microsoft Internet Explorer or Netscape Navigator.
- Go to the web address **<http://onet.rti.org>**.
- Click on the Login link to gain access to the questionnaire.
- Enter your **User ID** and **Password**. This information can be found on the label on the front cover of the questionnaire booklet that you received. Click on **OK**.
- Once you're logged in, you will receive further instructions on completing the questionnaire. If you have any problems accessing the web site, please call toll free 1-877-254-1949 or send email to [help@onet.rti.org](mailto:help@onet.rti.org).

If you have any questions at all, please feel free to contact [TBA] at RTI by telephone at 1-800-262-6651, or e-mail her at [TBA]. Call or e-mail Monday through Friday between 8:30 AM and 4:30 PM eastern time.